

- Use the object **Chart**  for presenting current data and results of the simulation run.
- Use the object **Checkbox**  for toggling between the states on and off, for toggling operating modes, etc.
- Use the object **Comment**  for showing explanatory notes which you added to your simulation model.
- Use the object **CostAnalyzer**  for analyzing costs that the individual *machines* and the *Worker* cause.
- Use the object **Dialog**  for designing a dialog box for an object which is similar to the built-in dialog boxes.
- Use the object **Display**  for presenting current data and results of the simulation run.
- Use the object **DropDownList**  for showing a drop-down list in the *Frame*. When you select one of the items, it executes the action which you programmed in the control.
- Use the object **GanttChart**  for showing the chronological sequence of activities as bars on the time axis.
- Use the object **HtmlReport**  for presenting current data and results of the simulation run in a report that you can share with co-workers and customers.
- Use the object **SankeyDiagram**  for visualizing the *Sankey flows* of parts as well as *Sankey flows* of *Workers*, who walk freely within the area or walk on *FootPaths*.

Comment

Comment [object]

Use the object *Comment* for showing explanatory notes which you added to your simulation model.

Image

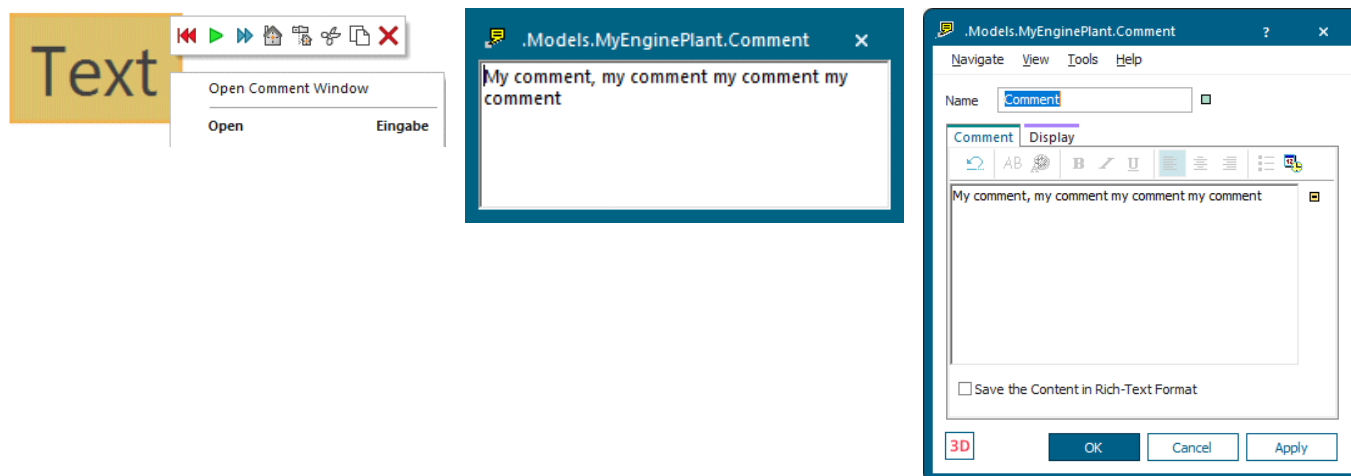


Description

A comment helps you and your colleagues to better understand the intentions behind your model and how it is supposed to work.

You can access it like you do any other object, be aware though that the *Comment* usually is not involved in the simulation itself. Select **Options > Show Comments** on the **View** ribbon tab of the *Frame* or click  to display all *Comment* objects, which you inserted into that *Frame*. *Plant Simulation* displays the text in the *Frame* window which you entered under **Display > Text**.

To open a window that only shows the comment you entered, without formatting and editing options, click the *Comment* object with the right mouse button and select **Open Comment Window** on the context menu.



To show a **tooltip** with information about the *Comment*, hover with the mouse over it.

To change the length of the graphic and the anchor points of the *Comment*, click **Show Manipulators**



on the **Edit** ribbon tab or press **M** on the keyboard.

Add the Object to the Simulation Model

To add the object *Comment* to your simulation model, click  **Manage Class Library > Basic Objects > UserInterface > Comment** on the **Home** ribbon tab.

See also

[Add Text and Display Boards](#)

Dialog Box of the Comment

Dialog Box of the Comment

Double-click the icon of the *Comment*, which you inserted into a *Frame*, to open its dialog box.

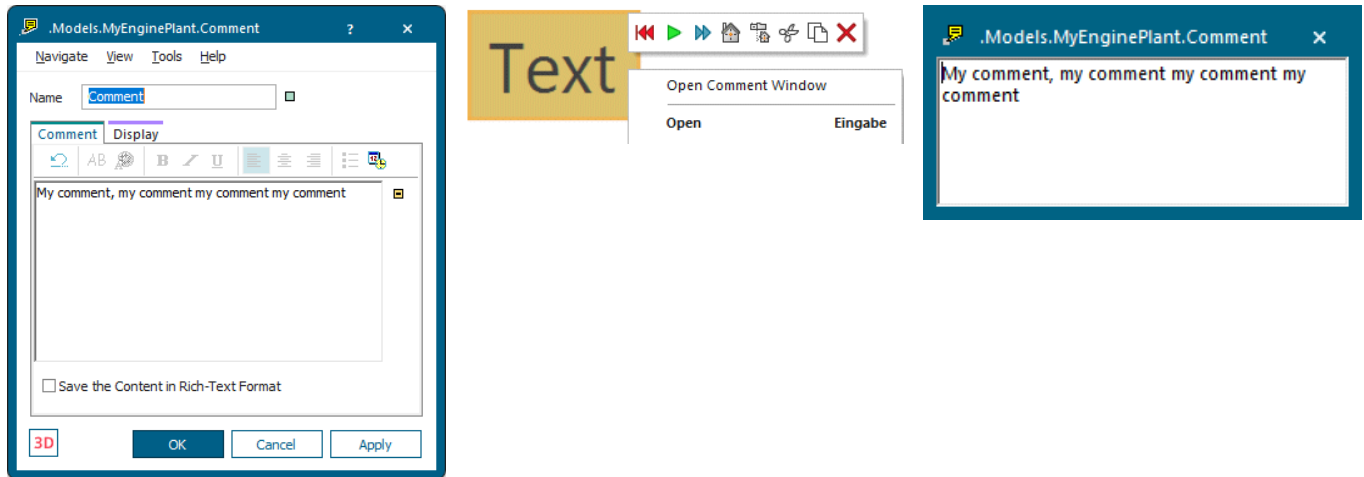
Edit Simulation Properties

To make the dialog box larger or smaller, grab any of its sides or corners, and drag the mouse.

To open a window that only shows the comment you entered, without formatting and editing options, click the *Comment* object with the right mouse button and select **Open Comment Window** on the context menu.

Plant Simulation opens the comment window with the size that the tab **Comment** in the dialog box had, when you entered the comment and with the formatting you applied.

To close the comment window, click **Close**  in the title bar.



Edit Animation Properties

To edit the **3D properties** of the object in the dialog box **Edit 3D Properties**:

- Click the button  **Edit 3D Properties** in the lower left corner of the simulation properties dialog box.
- Select the object in the model and press the **spacebar**.

To manipulate the graphic of the object, click **Show Manipulators** on the **Edit** ribbon tab or press **M** on the keyboard.

Name [text box] - Comment

Shows the name of the object here, either the predefined name or a name that you specify. To change the name, double-click and type over it.

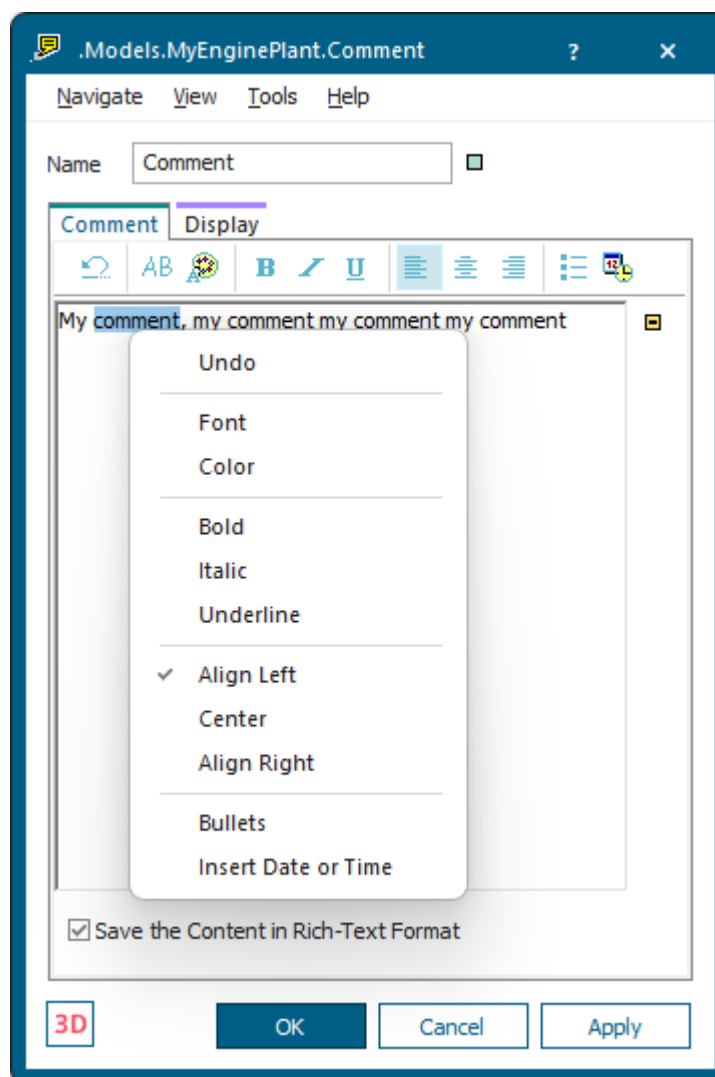
Name 

Remarks

You can type in a combination of letters, digits, and underscore (_) characters, for example MyComment, MyComment1, My_Comment_1. The name of an object cannot start with a digit, i.e., you cannot type in 1Comment.

SimTalk**Name [SimTalk] - general description****Tab Comment****Tab Comment [Comment]**

Type a detailed description appending the short note you entered into the **Text** box on the **Tab Display**.

**Note**

The formatting properties only apply if you select ☒ **Save the Content in Rich-Text Format**.

- Apply formatting properties to the selected text with the buttons of the **Formatting Toolbar**



or the commands of the **Context Menu for Formatting the Comment**.

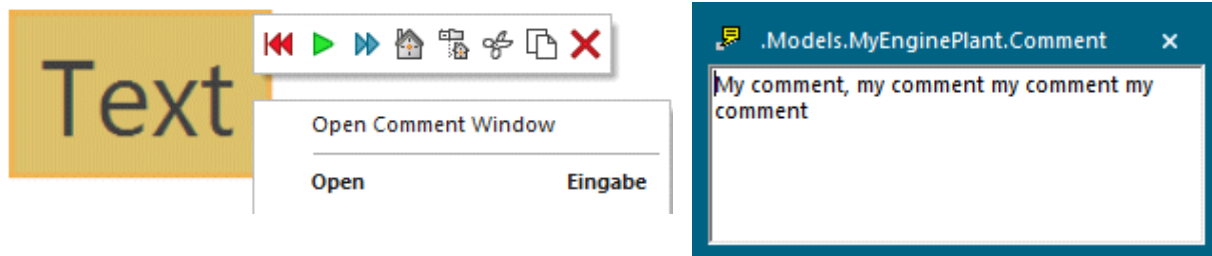
Note

The buttons are only active if you select the check box **Save the Content in Rich-text Format**.

- For each **character format** property you can:
 - Apply a typeface, a **Font** size, and a font color.
 - Apply **Bold** face, **Underline**, or **italicize** text.

- For each **paragraph format** property you may:
 - ◊ Set the alignment: [Align Left](#), [Center](#), or [Align Right](#).
 - ◊ Set an indentation with [Bullets](#).
- Or copy text you **formatted** in a word processing application that works with rich text format (.rtf), such as the MS Windows WordPad or MS Word, to the clipboard and paste that text, including all of its formatting properties into the text box.
- Or type text into the text box, copy it back to the word processing application, apply formatting and paste it back to the text box. Press **Ctrl+A** to select all of the text into the text box, **Ctrl+C** to copy the text, and **Ctrl+V** to paste it.

To open a window that only shows the comment you typed in, without formatting and editing options, click the *Comment* object with the right mouse button and select [Open Comment Window](#) on the context menu.



SimTalk

[Cont \[SimTalk\] - Comment](#)

[appendToContent \[SimTalk\]](#)

[openComment \[SimTalk\]](#)

See also

[Inherit Contents \[Comment\]](#)

Formatting Toolbar

Apply formatting properties to the selected text in rtf format with the buttons on the toolbar.

The settings only apply when you select **Save the Content in Rich-text Format**.



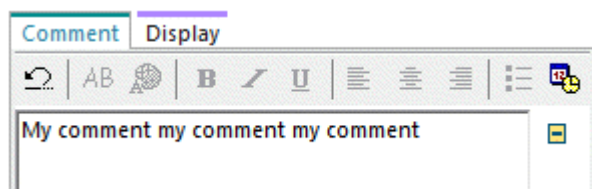
To do this	Click	Attribute
Undo your most recent action.		—
Open the dialog Font . Then, select a Font , a Font style , the font Size , and font Effects .		Font [SimTalk] - Comment
Open the dialog Colors . Select a Color for the selected text.		Color [SimTalk] - Comment
Apply bold face to the text which you selected in the text box.		—
<i>Italicize</i> the text which you selected in the text box.		—
Underline the text which you selected in the text box.		—
Align the text on the left.		—
Center the text.		—
Align the text on the right.		—
Add bullets in front of the text which you selected in the text box. Press Enter to insert a line break in front of a sentence where you want to add a bullet.		—
Open the dialog Insert Date and Time . Select one of the available formats from the list box.		—

Note

You can also select most of the formatting options on the **Context Menu for Formatting the Comment**.

Inherit Contents [Comment]

To inherit or not inherit the contents of the *Comment*, click the **inheritance** check box next to the text box.



Save the Content in Rich-text Format

To save the contents of the text box in rich-text format, which preserves all of the formatting properties which you applied, select this check box.

☒ Save the Content in Rich-Text Format

Remarks

When you select the check box, *Plant Simulation* activates the settings of the **Formatting Toolbar** and on the **Context Menu for Formatting the Comment**.

SimTalk

SaveAsRichedit [SimTalk]

Context Menu for Formatting the Comment

Context Menu for Formatting the Comment

The context menu provides the menu commands listed in the table of contents to the left.

Note

You can also select the formatting options on the **Formatting Toolbar**



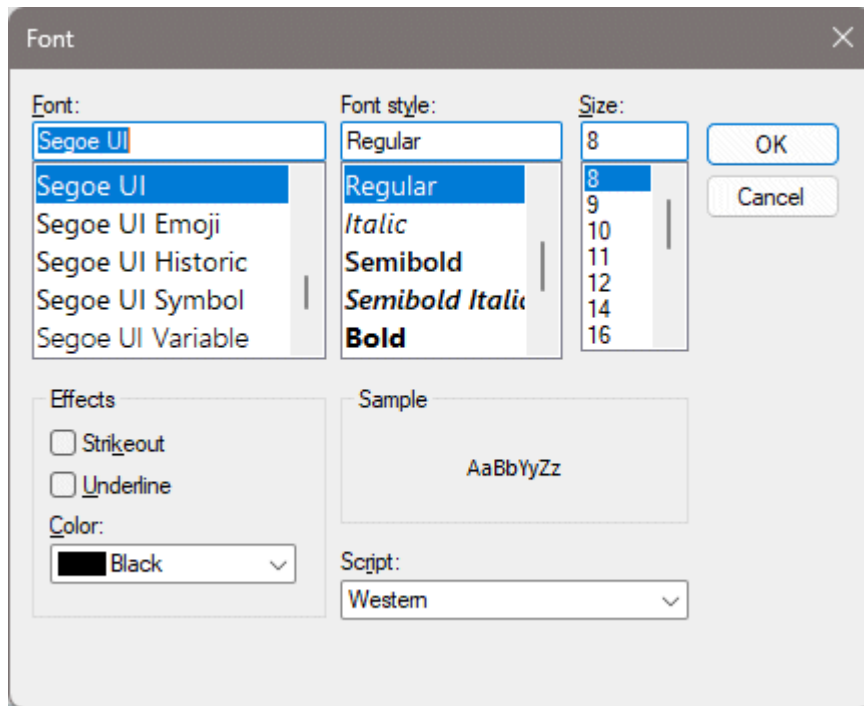
Undo [Comment]

Undoes your most recent action.

Instead, you can also click  on the **Formatting Toolbar** .

Font [Comment]

Select font settings for displaying the *Comment* in the dialog **Font**.



Remarks

You can:

- Select the **Font**, the **Font Style**, the font **Size**, and font **Effects**.
- Click **OK** to apply these settings to the text, which you selected in the text box.

Instead, you can also click  the **Formatting Toolbar** .

See also

[Font \[SimTalk\] - Comment](#)

Color [Comment]

Select color settings for displaying the *Comment* in the dialog **Color**.

Remarks

Proceed as follows to set a color:

- Select a **Color**.
- Click **Apply** to apply these settings to the selected text into the text box and leave the dialog open.
- Click **OK** to apply this color to the selected text into the text box and close the dialog.

Instead, you can also click  on the **Formatting Toolbar** .

See also

[Color \[SimTalk\] - Comment](#)

Bold [Comment]

Applies **bold** face to the text which you selected in the text box.

Instead, you can also click  on the **Formatting Toolbar** .

Italic [Comment]

Italicizes the text which you selected in the text box.

Instead, you can also click  on the **Formatting Toolbar** .

Underline

Underlines the text which you selected in the text box.

Instead, you can also click  on the **Formatting Toolbar** .

Align Left

Aligns the text on the left.

Instead, you can also click  on the **Formatting Toolbar** .

Center [Comment]

Centers the text.

Instead, you can also click  on the **Formatting Toolbar** .

Align Right

Aligns the text on the right.

Instead, you can also click  on the **Formatting Toolbar** .

Bullets

Adds a bullet in front of the text which you selected in the text box.

Remarks

Press **Enter** to insert a line break in front of a sentence where you want to add a bullet.

Instead, you can also click  on the **Formatting Toolbar** .

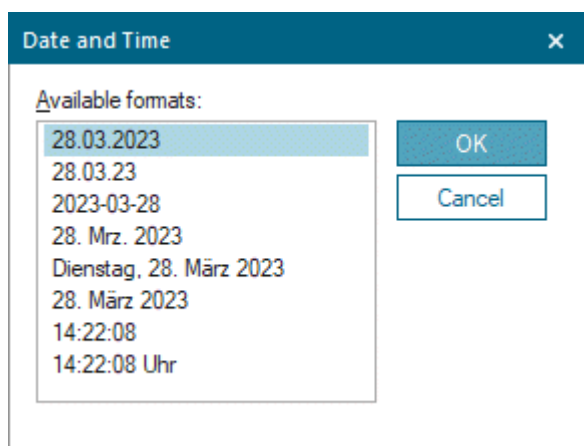
Insert Date or Time

Opens the dialog **Insert Date and Time**.

Remarks

Proceed as follows to insert a date and a time into the comment:

- Select one of the available formats from the list box.
- Click **OK** to enter this time or date at the position of the cursor into the text box.



Instead, you can also click  on the **Formatting Toolbar** .

Tab Display

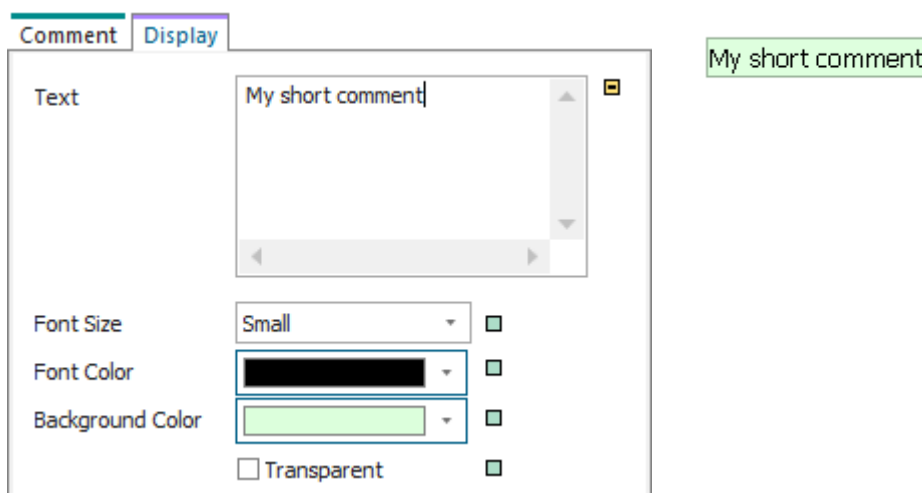
Tab Display

On the tab **Display** you can select how to display the *Comment* in your simulation model.

The tab **Display** provides the settings listed in the table of contents to the left.

Text [text box] - Comment

Type in the text that *Plant Simulation* shows when you insert the *Comment* object into a *Frame*.



Remarks

Type in a short text, or you will not be able to see or select the *Comment* in the *Frame*.

If you only entered **Text** here and nothing on the tab **Comment**, *Plant Simulation* shows the tab **Display** when you open the dialog of the *Comment* the next time.

Inherit text

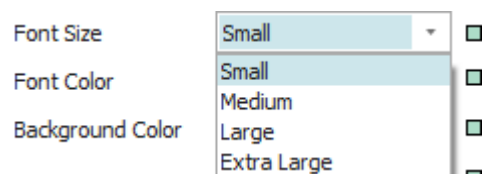
To inherit ☒ or not inherit ☐ the **Text** of the *Comment*, which you type into the box to the left, click the **inheritance** check box.

SimTalk

Text [SimTalk] - Comment

Font Size [drop-down list] - Comment

Select a font size for displaying the *Comment* in the *Frame* into which you inserted it.



SimTalk

Font [SimTalk] - Comment

Font Color [Comment]

To select the color of the text proper with which *Plant Simulation* shows the *Comment* in the *Frame*, click the drop-down arrow.

Font Size	Small	☐
Font Color	Black	☐
Background Color	Light Green	☐
☐ Transparent		☐

Remarks

Plant Simulation only shows the color in the *Frame* into which you inserted the *Comment*, not in the open dialog box.

My short comment

You can select one of the predefined colors, or you can click **More Colors** and click the **Select** button to select a color in the color matrix. Then click **OK**. *Plant Simulation* shows this color next to **More Colors** and uses it as the active color.

SimTalk

Color [SimTalk] - Comment

Background Color [drop-down list] - Comment

To select the color of the background of the *Comment* which you inserted into a *Frame*, click the drop-down arrow.

Font Size	Small	▼	■
Font Color		▼	■
Background Color		▼	■
☐ Transparent			■

Remarks

You can select one of the predefined colors, or you can click **More Colors** and click the **Select** button to select a color in the color matrix. Then click **OK**. *Plant Simulation* shows this color next to **More Colors** and uses it as the active color.

My short comment

SimTalk

BackgroundColor [SimTalk] - Comment

Transparent [check box] - Comment

To make the background of a *Comment* object, which you inserted into a *Frame*, shine through the hollow parts of the text, select this check box.

☒ Transparent 

Remarks

With a **Transparent Background**, *Plant Simulation* shows the *Comment* in the color which you selected as the **Font Color** on the background of the *Frame*.

To show the text on a white background, clear the check box.

Not transparent	Transparent
	

SimTalk

Transparent [SimTalk] - Comment

Navigate Menu

The commands are described under the [Navigate Menu](#).

View Menu

The commands are described under the [View Menu](#).

SimTalk

[updateDialog \[SimTalk\]](#)

Tools Menu

The **Tools Menu** provides commands to access its functions.

Edit Observers

Help Menu

The commands are described under the [Help Menu](#).

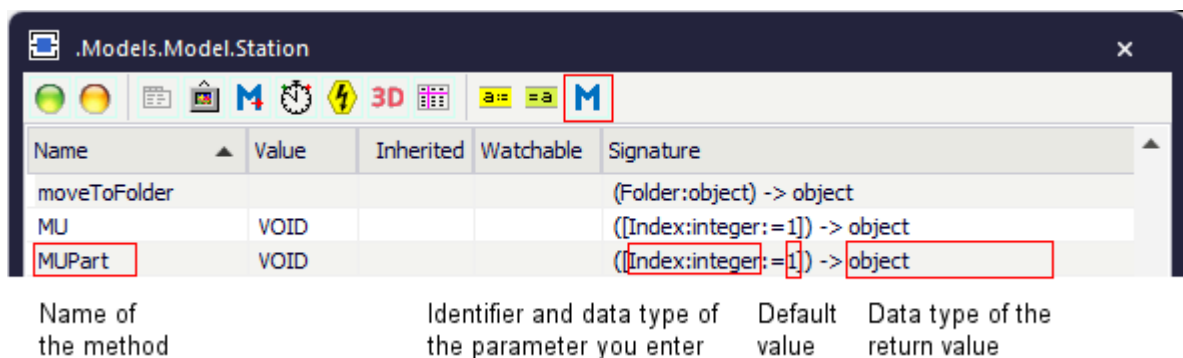
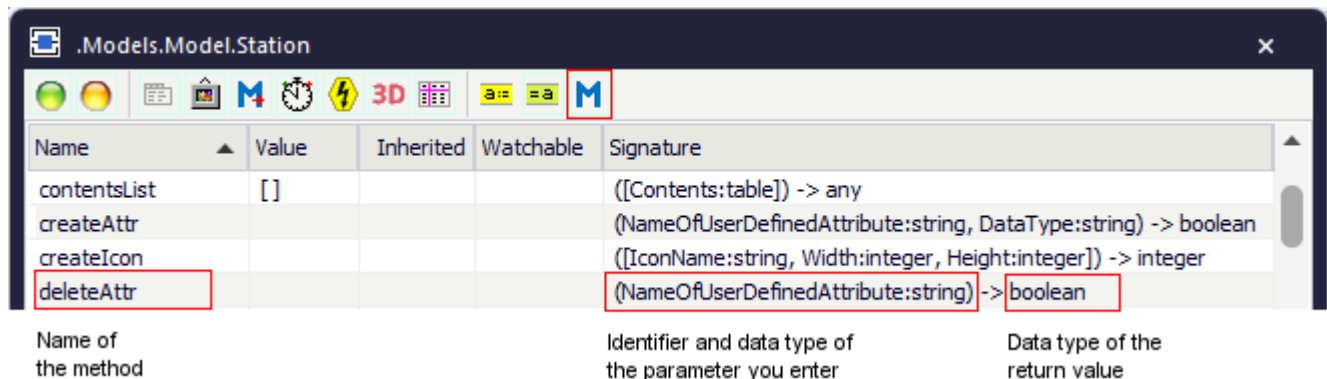
Methods of the Comment

_Methods of the Comment

The *Comment* provides:

- The *methods* listed in the table of contents to the left.
- The [Methods of All Objects](#).

To view all of the *methods*, *read-only attributes*, and *attributes* of the object, open the window [Show Attributes and Methods](#). The figure below illustrates the information using the example of the object *Station*.



- Select **Show Attributes and Methods** on the context menu of the **Class Library** to show the *methods*, *read-only attributes*, and *attributes* of the selected [Class \[general description\]](#).
- Press the **F8** key or click **Show Attributes and Methods** on the **Home** ribbon tab of the *Frame* into which you inserted an instance to show the *methods*, *read-only attributes*, and *attributes* of the selected [Instance \[general description\]](#).